

****On the Occasion of the 5th Anniversary of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)****

On May 5, 2023, a consultation on personal data protection titled “5 Years of GDPR Implementation: Issues, Solutions, Penalties, and Examples of Good Practice” was held, organized by the Agency for Personal Data Protection, the Croatian Chamber of Economy, and the University of North.

Approximately one hundred data controllers/processors and data protection officers had the opportunity to familiarize themselves with the latest trends and examples of good practice in the field of personal data protection, share with experts from the Agency the problems they encounter in the application of the General Data Protection Regulation, which has been fully applicable in the European Union since May 25, 2018, and, with the support of experts, find solutions that will elevate the level of compliance in their organizations to a higher standard.

“It is high time that all data controllers/processors realize that the deadline for adjustment has passed and that after five years of full application of the General Data Protection Regulation, ignorance and lack of knowledge can no longer serve as justification and excuse for violating the fundamental rights of Croatian citizens. Therefore, by organizing such educational events, we assist data controllers/processors in addressing all the uncertainties they face when aligning with the General Data Protection Regulation,” said the director of the Agency, Zdravko Vukić.

“Investing in personal data protection is an investment that guarantees survival in the market, especially for the private sector, but also for all other organizations. Protecting informational assets and preserving capital is a significant and responsible task for all of us,” stated Petar Mišević, advisor to the president of the Croatian Chamber of Economy and prorector of the University of North.

In its advisory role, the Agency continuously organizes various educational activities aimed at all target groups, primarily data controllers/processors and data protection officers. However, the educational and supervisory activities conducted show that the level of compliance with the legislative framework for data protection in Croatia is still not at a satisfactory level. For this reason, the Agency has intensified its supervisory activities this year and last, resulting in the highest number of administrative monetary fines imposed for violations of legal regulations on personal data protection—this year alone, 13 administrative monetary fines were issued, totaling 2.3 million euros.

Indeed, penalties for violators of the GDPR and the Law on the Implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation were one of the topics of the consultation. Additionally, Agency officials discussed aligning business processes with the GDPR, specifically where organizations most commonly err; technical and organizational measures for data protection—examples of good practice; how to prepare for the Agency's supervisory and investigative activities; and the advisory activities of the Agency for Personal Data Protection—ARC 2 project and the coordinated action of the European Data Protection Board aimed at data protection officers.

Zdravko Vukić, Director

Petar Mišević, Advisor to the President of the Croatian Chamber of Economy and Prorector of the University of North.

Igor Vulje, Deputy Director

****Audience****

ARC 2, Guidance - 10 Steps to Comply with the GDPR

****Audience****